THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

CBSE / RBSE • NURSERY – CLASS XII • JAIPUR

Road No. 5, VKIA, Jaipur — 9887258679

CLASS 9 ENGLISH — READING SKILL PAPER SET 04

Reading Comprehension | RBSE Board Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 45 Minutes Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 20**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Section A has one passage with 12 questions (1 mark each).
3. Section B has one case-based passage with 8 questions (1 mark each).
4. Questions include MCQs and short answers of 30–40 words.
5. Write the question number before each answer.
6. Answers must be written in the answer book in the order of the questions.

SECTION — A (Reading Comprehension: Factual / Discursive Passage, 400–450 words) 12 Marks

Read the passage and answer the questions.

1. *Read the passage carefully and answer the questions that follow.* 12

A hundred years ago, news travelled slowly. A letter might take a week to cross the country, and a telegram was sent only in an emergency. Today a photograph clicked in a village can reach another continent in a few seconds. Speed has become the pride of our age, but it has also changed how we listen.

When people received a single letter, they read it several times and replied with care. Today a hundred messages arrive in an hour, and most are answered with a quick emoji or not at all. The result is that we know a great deal about many people and very little about any one of them.

The speed of news has brought great benefits. A cyclone warning reaches fishing villages within minutes, giving families time to move to safe places. Doctors in distant towns consult specialists through video calls, and a farmer can check the price of his crop in the city market before deciding where to sell. Information that once belonged to the rich and the educated now reaches almost everyone with a phone.

But speed has a price. A rumour travels as fast as a fact, and often faster, because it is simpler and more exciting. Before the sun sets, a false message can frighten a whole town. Wise readers therefore ask three questions before they believe or forward any report: who wrote it, what proof is given, and has any trustworthy source said the same? A moment of doubt is a small price to pay for the truth.

Schools can prepare young people for this world by teaching them to read the news the way a detective reads a scene. Compare two reports of the same event. Notice which words are chosen to excite and which to inform. Look for the date, the source and the number behind every claim. Such habits turn the reader from a passive listener into an active judge. In an age when anyone can publish, the most valuable skill is not speed in sharing but patience in checking, for a society that cannot tell fact from rumour cannot take sound decisions.

Conversation suffers the most. At a family meal, one can often see each member looking at a small screen instead of at one another. Grandparents wait to tell a story, and no one hears. This does not mean that technology is to blame. It means that we have to choose when to put it aside. A fixed 'no-phone' hour at dinner or on Sundays can bring back the lost habit of listening, which is the beginning of friendship.

(i) A hundred years ago, a letter might take: 1

(a) a week to cross the country **(b)** a year

(c) a minute **(d)** an hour

(ii) The writer says that today we know: 1

(a) everything about everybody
(b) much about one person
(c) a lot about many people and little about any one
(d) nothing about anybody

(iii) According to the passage, conversation suffers because: 1

(a) people speak too loudly
(b) people look at screens instead of each other
(c) families are small
(d) there are no meals

(iv) 'Pride of our age' refers to: 1

(a) telegrams **(b)** letters **(c)** silence **(d)** speed

(v) The writer's suggestion is to: 1

(a) stop sending messages
(b) use only letters
(c) fix a no-phone hour
(d) ban phones

(vi) What was a telegram used for? 1

(vii) How did people treat a single letter earlier? 1

(viii) Who waits to tell a story but is not heard? 1

(ix) Find a word which means 'put away'. 1

(x) What does the writer call 'the beginning of friendship'? 1

(xi) Which is NOT a benefit of fast news mentioned? 1

(a) Farmers can check crop prices
(b) Rumours spread faster
(c) Doctors can consult specialists
(d) Cyclone warnings reach villages quickly

(xii) What three questions should a wise reader ask about a report? 1

SECTION — B (Reading Comprehension: Case-based Passage, 200–250 words) — 8 Marks

Read the text and answer the questions.

2. *Read the following case and answer the questions that follow.* 8

The Rajasthan Tourism Department has released a notice for the Pushkar Fair visitors. The fair will be held for eight days, beginning on 1 November. Visitors are advised to book accommodation at least a month in advance, as hotels and tented camps fill quickly. The department has set up a help desk near the bus stand, open from 7 a.m. to 9 p.m., where maps, schedules and emergency numbers are available free of charge.

To keep the town clean, visitors must not throw rubbish in the open. Dustbins in green and blue colours have been placed at every hundred metres: green for wet waste and blue for dry waste. Plastic bags below fifty microns are banned, and a fine of five hundred rupees will be charged to anyone found littering. Camel and horse rides near the sacred lake are allowed only in the marked area, and children must be accompanied by an adult.

Free medical camps will operate near the main ground in the mornings. Cultural programmes, including folk music and puppet shows, will be held every evening at the open-air stage. Entry to the programmes is free, but visitors are requested to be seated before 6:30 p.m.

For further information, visitors may call the department's toll-free helpline or visit its website, where the full programme of the fair, including the timings of the camel race and the cattle show, has been uploaded.

(i) The fair will be held for: 1

(a) eight days **(b)** two weeks **(c)** five days **(d)** ten days

(ii) The help desk is located near the: 1

(a) bus stand
(b) sacred lake
(c) main ground
(d) open-air stage

(iii) Dustbins for wet waste are: 1

(a) red **(b)** green **(c)** blue **(d)** yellow

(iv) What is the fine for littering? 1

(a) One hundred rupees **(b)** Fifty rupees

(c) Five hundred rupees **(d)** One thousand rupees

(v) Why should visitors book accommodation a month ahead? 1

(vi) What is available at the help desk? 1

(vii) Where are camel and horse rides allowed? 1

(viii) Name one cultural programme mentioned. 1

END OF QUESTION PAPER **Total: 20 Marks**

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